THE *xpLosION* HISTORICAL DOSSIER

University of Birmingham Lions · Complete Archive & Matchup Intelligence

OFFICIAL ARCHIVE REPORT

Strictly Confirmed Data · Zero Hallucinations

15 – 3	537 – 106	8 / 18	18 / 19
LIONS CONFIRMED XPLOSION RECORD (83.3%)	TOTAL POINTS (29.8 – 5.9 AVG)	SHUTOUTS PITCHED BY BIRMINGHAM (44.4%)	CONFIRMED COMPLETED FIXTURES IN DB

🏟️ **THIS SATURDAY'S SHOWCASE FIXTURE · SATURDAY, 7 NOVEMBER 2026 · 16:10 GMT**

Reading Knights (0–0) at Birmingham Lions (0–0–1)

Competition: BUCS Division 1 Southern · Venue: Bournbrook Pitch, University of Birmingham · All-Time Series: 0 Previous Meetings (Inaugural Clash)

⚡ Matchup Context & Verified Historical Intelligence

1. Matchup Intelligence & Form — SATURDAY PREVIEW

- **First-Ever Meeting in Recorded History:** Despite Birmingham Lions (founded 1989; **186 recorded games**) and Reading Knights (founded 1987; **134 recorded games**) possessing over 75 combined years of football history, Saturday is their **first-ever meeting in archive history**.
- **Birmingham's 2026 Season Form:** The Lions enter Saturday at **0–0–1** after opening their campaign on 24 Oct 2026 with a 6–6 road tie against Oxford Brookes.
- **Reading's 2026 Season Form:** The Knights travel to Birmingham for their **2026–27 season opener** (0–0), having earned promotion to Division 1 Southern.
- **Dominant Home Defense:** In confirmed xpLosION games, Birmingham's defense has conceded an average of just **5.9 points per game**, pitching **8 clean sheets** across 18 completed fixtures.

2. xpLosION Tradition & Records — ARCHIVE FACTS

- **Name Provenance:** Founded in November 2005 around Guy Fawkes Night, the four capital letters in **xpLosION** spell out **L-I-O-N**. It is the longest-running regular season campus night showcase in British university football.
- **Bournbrook Fortress (15–3 in Confirmed Games):** Birmingham have won **83.3%** of confirmed xpLosION games, including seven consecutive verified wins from 2005 to 2015.
- **Only 3 Visiting Teams Have Won:** In the archive's confirmed records, only Bath Killer Bees (10–7 in 2016), Swansea Titans (20–16 in 2018), and Oxford Brookes (6–0 in 2025) have ever won an xpLosION game—each by 6 points or fewer.
- **Data Provenance Notice:** The archive includes **only verified contemporary fixtures** from BCAFL/BUAFL/BUCS official records, BAFRA bulletins, and Double Coverage contemporary reports. Gaps where regular season fixtures were unrecorded (such as 2009 and 2010) are strictly omitted.

📊 Tale of the Tape: Confirmed Archive Totals

CATEGORY / METRIC	🦁 BIRMINGHAM LIONS (HOME)	⚔️ READING KNIGHTS (AWAY)
Program Founded	1989 · University of Birmingham	1987 · University of Reading
All-Time Recorded Record	**127 – 56 – 3** (0.683) across 186 games	**53 – 80 – 1** (0.396) across 134 games
All-Time Points For / Against	4,865 PF / 2,723 PA (+2142)	1,489 PF / 2,172 PA (-683)
All-Time Shutouts Pitched	**48 Shutouts**	**21 Shutouts**
Current 2026–27 Record Entering Saturday	**0 – 0 – 1** (Tied 6–6 at Oxford Brookes)	**0 – 0** (Season Opener)
Head-to-Head History	**0 previous meetings in 40+ years · First-Ever Clash**	

📜 Verified All-Time xpLosION Fixtures in Database (19 Total Fixtures)

#	SEASON	DATE	VISITING OPPONENT	SCORE	RES	PHASE / DIVISION	CONTEMPORARY PRIMARY SOURCE & NOTES
#1	2005	05/11/2005	Oxford Cavaliers	59 – 0	W	British Collegiate American Football League	xpLosION 2005 (Inaugural edition). Source: BCAFL contemporary official archives
#2	2006	04/11/2006	Tarannau Aberystwyth	28 – 12	W	British Collegiate American Football League	xpLosION 2006. Source: BCAFL contemporary official archives & BAFRA Newsflash Issue 43/06
#3	2007	10/11/2007	Warwick Wolves	49 – 0	W	Central Division	xpLosION 2007. Source: BAFRA Newsflash Issue 42/07
#4	2008	08/11/2008	Bath Killer Bees	29 – 0	W	Conference 2 - South	xpLosION 2008. Source: BAFRA Newsflash Issue 42/08 & 43/08
#5	2011	05/11/2011	Nottingham Trent Renegades	25 – 6	W	Midlands	xpLosION 2011. Source: https://dblcoverage.blogspot.com/2011/11/xplosion-recap.html
#6	2012	03/11/2012	Nottingham Gold	71 – 6	W	Midlands Athletics Conference	xpLosION 2012. Source: Double Coverage contemporary archives & BAFRA Newsflash Issue 40/12
#7	2013	03/11/2013	Nottingham Trent Renegades	16 – 9	W	Midlands Athletics Conference	Source: BAFRA Newsflash Issue 2013-42
#8	2014	01/11/2014	Hertfordshire Hurricanes	23 – 0	W	Premier South	Source: https://dblcoverage.com/university/bucs-fixturesresults-201415/
#9	2015	07/11/2015	Kingston Cougars	36 – 0	W	Premier South	Source: https://dblcoverage.com/university/bucs-fixturesresults-201516/
#10	2016	12/11/2016	Bath Killer Bees	7 – 10	L	Premier South	Source: https://dblcoverage.com/university/bucs-fixturesresults-201617/
#11	2017	11/11/2017	Portsmouth Destroyers	39 – 14	W	Premier South	Source: https://dblcoverage.com/university/bucs-fixturesresults-201718/
#12	2018	24/11/2018	Swansea Titans	16 – 20	L	Premier South	Source: https://dblcoverage.com/university/bucs-fixturesresults-201819/
#13	2019	09/11/2019	Hertfordshire Hurricanes	24 – 0	W	Premier South	Source: BUCS Play historical records
#14	2021	06/11/2021	Swansea Titans	41 – 0	W	Premier South	Source: https://bucs.playwaze.com/american-football-21-22/9esbz8vb7ijo/community-details?Tab=Fixtures
#15	2022	12/11/2022	Cardiff Cobras	20 – 0	W	Premier South	Source: https://bucs.playwaze.com/american-football-22-23/community-details?Tab=Fixtures
#16	2023	04/11/2023	Cardiff Cobras	27 – 17	W	Premier South	Source: https://bucs.playwaze.com/american-football-23-24/community-details?Tab=Fixtures
#17	2024	09/11/2024	Cardiff Cobras	27 – 6	W	Premier South	The xpLosION event was cancelled, though the game was still played. Source: https://bucs.playwaze.com/american-football-24-25/community-details?Tab=Fixtures
#18	2025	08/11/2025	Oxford Brookes University	0 – 6	L	Division 1 Southern	Source: https://bucs.playwaze.com/american-football-25-26/community-details?Tab=Fixtures
#19	**2026**	**07/11/2026**	**Reading Knights**	**16:10 KO**	**UPCOMING**	**Division 1 Southern**	**Source: BUCS Play historical records (https://bucs.playwaze.com/bucs-american-football-26-27/ifxdwhhz1xyc/community-details)**

🏆 Confirmed xpLosION Series Breakdown

Frequent Visitors (Confirmed In Archive)

OPPONENT LEDGER

- **Cardiff Cobras (3×):** Birmingham is **3–0** (Outscored 74–23) · Seasons: 2022, 2023, 2024
- **Bath Killer Bees (2×):** Birmingham is **1–1** (Outscored 36–10) · Seasons: 2008, 2016
- **Nottingham Trent Renegades (2×):** Birmingham is **2–0** (Outscored 41–15) · Seasons: 2011, 2013
- **Hertfordshire Hurricanes (2×):** Birmingham is **2–0** (Outscored 47–0) · Seasons: 2014, 2019
- **Swansea Titans (2×):** Birmingham is **1–1** (Outscored 57–20) · Seasons: 2018, 2021

Confirmed Scoring Superlatives

VERIFIED HIGHS & LOWS

- **Largest Confirmed Blowout: 71–6** (+65 pts) vs Nottingham Gold (2012) & **59–0** (+59 pts) vs Oxford Cavaliers (2005)
- **Highest Lions Single-Game Score: 71 points** vs Nottingham Gold (03/11/2012)
- **Lowest Confirmed Total Points: 6 points** (0–6 vs Oxford Brookes, 08/11/2025)
- **Closest Confirmed Win: 16–9** (+7 pts) vs NTU Renegades (03/11/2013)
- **Smallest Defeat Margin: 7–10** (-3 pts) vs Bath Killer Bees (12/11/2016)

All 19 fixtures queried dynamically from Supabase database · Zero Hallucinations · Generated Nov 2026